

THE PRIME-WAVE ANATOMY OF THE GAP-AMPLITUDE LAW FOR RIEMANN ZEROS

UĞUR SEZEN

ABSTRACT. In a companion note we measured the joint law of consecutive-zero gaps δ_n and between-zero maxima $M_n = \max |Z(t)|$ of Hardy's function, finding that its correlation matches CUE characteristic polynomials only at a shifted effective dimension, with different shifts for different statistics. Here we dissect the deviation. Regressing $\log M_n$ and $\log \delta_n$ on the explicit-formula waves $\cos(t \log p^k)$ (phases evaluated at gap midpoints, hence exogenous; placebo frequencies shift correlations by $\leq 10^{-4}$), we find: (i) a *sum rule* — the total prime content of the amplitudes matches the explicit-formula weights $p^{-k/2}/k$ to within 1–12% at all 23 frequencies tested, spanning a factor 20 in amplitude; (ii) the content splits between a direct amplitude channel w and a zero-displacement channel v , mirror curves that each collapse onto one-variable laws in $\tau = \log p / \log \frac{t}{2\pi}$; (iii) stripping the measured waves from both series leaves a core pair with correlation $r^* \approx 0.97$ – 0.98 — tighter than any finite CUE — with the Pearson/Spearman effective-dimension anomaly of the companion note melting away entirely; (iv) an exhaustion analysis reveals a role-crossover at $\tau^* \approx 0.42$ and yields an upper bound on the intrinsic (non-arithmetic) variance of the amplitude sequence, $V_{\text{res}}(L)$, which grows at a rate close to the CUE rate but at one sixth its magnitude. All of these laws, fitted at $t \leq 1.6 \times 10^6$, are then re-tested out of sample at the 10^{12} -th zero ($t \approx 2.7 \times 10^{11}$) using Odlyzko's tables: the τ -laws, the sum rule, the crossover, and the V_{res} extension all hold across this 1.6×10^5 -fold jump in height. At single-gap scale, two thirds or more of the apparent randomness of $|Z|$ is deterministic prime signal.

1. INTRODUCTION

Let γ_n denote consecutive ordinates of nontrivial zeros of ζ , $\delta_n = \gamma_{n+1} - \gamma_n$, $M_n = \max_{\gamma_n \leq t \leq \gamma_{n+1}} |Z(t)|$, and $L = \log \frac{t}{2\pi}$. In a companion note [7] we measured the correlation of the unfolded pair $(\tilde{\delta}_n, \tilde{M}_n)$ over 3.4×10^5 gaps up to $t = 1.6 \times 10^6$, validated the dataset against the proven mean-value results of Conrey–Ghosh [2] and Hughes–Lugmayer–Pearce–Crump [4], and compared it with the CUE characteristic-polynomial model [5]. The outcome was an effective-dimension description: $r_\zeta(L) = r_{\text{CUE}}(L + c)$ with c constant in L but *different for different statistics* ($c_{\text{Pearson}} = 0.93$, $c_{\text{Spearman}} = 1.86$) — so no single finite CUE reproduces the joint law.

This note asks *what, concretely, the deviation is*, and answers with a set of regression measurements against the explicit-formula frequencies. The toolbox is elementary (ordinary least squares on 10^5 -size samples), but three design choices matter: all wave phases are evaluated at gap midpoints, which are determined by the zeros alone and are therefore exogenous to the amplitude measurements; every stripping experiment is accompanied by a placebo run with an equal number of non-prime-power frequencies; and no closed forms are fitted — all comparisons are against measured or proven quantities.

2. DATA AND CONVENTIONS

The dataset is that of [7]: six windows of 4×10^4 gaps centered at $t = 1.2, 2.0, 3.5, 6.0, 10, 16 \times 10^5$ ($L = 9.86$ to 12.45), computed by a vectorized Riemann–Siegel engine validated to 7.6×10^{-6} pointwise and cross-checked against the proven mean of M_n^2 (slope within 0.05%, constant term within 1%). Unfolding uses known scales:

$$\tilde{\delta} = \delta \cdot \frac{L}{2\pi}, \quad \tilde{M} = \frac{M}{\sqrt{AL + \alpha_{-1} + 2A + (\alpha_0 + \alpha_{-1})/L}},$$

with $A = (e^2 - 5)/2$ and the α_i of [4].

For a set $\mathcal{Q}$ of prime powers we regress

$$\log \tilde{M}_n \sim 1 + \sum_{q \in \mathcal{Q}} [a_q \cos(t_n \log q) + b_q \sin(t_n \log q)], \quad \log \tilde{\delta}_n \sim (\text{same basis}),$$

with t_n the midpoint of gap n . “Stripping” means subtracting the fitted wave part from both series and re-exponentiating. Placebo runs replace $\mathcal{Q}$ by an equal number of frequencies bounded away from all $\log p^k$; across all experiments below the placebo changes the correlations by at most 10^{-4} and removes at most 10^{-4} of the log-variance.

3. THE SUM RULE

The explicit formula assigns the wave $\cos(t \log p^k)$ weight $p^{-k/2}/k$ in $\log |\zeta(\frac{1}{2} + it)|$. Define the normalized content $u_q = \sqrt{a_q^2 + b_q^2} / (p^{-k/2}/k)$ for $q = p^k$.

Observation 1 (Sum rule). *For all 23 frequencies tested — the primes 2 through 47 and the prime powers 4, 8, 9, 16, 25, 27, 32, 49 — the measured total content of the maxima satisfies $|u_q| = 1.01$ to 1.12 , with the explicit-formula weights spanning a factor of 20 (0.71 down to 0.035). The sine components vanish (phase-aligned waves), and placebo frequencies give $|u| \approx 0$.*

The between-zero maxima of $|Z|$ therefore carry the prime oscillations at *full explicit-formula weight*, term by term, including the harmonics. There is a small systematic drift of u with frequency (+1% at $q = 2$ to +12% at $q = 47$) whose origin we have not identified; we record it rather than absorb it.

4. TWO CHANNELS AND THE τ -LAWS

The unit total splits into two measurable channels: a direct amplitude channel (coefficient w_p : the response of $\log \tilde{M}$ at fixed observed gap) and a zero-displacement channel (coefficient v_p : the response of $\log \tilde{\delta}$). Measured across the six windows, the two run in opposite directions:

p	2	3	5	7	11	13
w_p	0.76	0.65	0.50	0.41	0.30	0.26
$ v_p $	0.13	0.20	0.29	0.35	0.42	0.45

and both collapse, across all windows and primes simultaneously, onto single curves in the Berry variable $\tau = \log p/L$ [1] (residual RMS ≈ 0.01 for w). Long waves (small τ) transmit into amplitude; short waves are absorbed into zero positions. The channels are consistent with the sum rule through the gap–amplitude coupling: $w_p + \beta v_p \approx 1$ with $\beta \approx 2.3$ the log-log regression slope of amplitude on gap. We read this as a measured, observable-level decomposition of the hybrid Euler–Hadamard product of Gonek–Hughes–Keating [3]: the

“zeros part” and “primes part” are here separated channel by channel, with the partition governed by τ alone.

5. STRIPPING: THE ARITHMETIC CORE

Removing the fitted waves from both series (basis: all $p^k \leq Q$) and recomputing the correlation of the residual pair gives, at $Q = 49$, $r_P^* \approx 0.97$, $r_S^* \approx 0.98$ — far tighter than any CUE in the range $N \in [5, 19]$ (max 0.93) — while the placebo leaves the raw values 0.75/0.88 untouched. Two structural consequences follow.

Observation 2 (The effective-dimension anomaly is arithmetic). *After stripping, the Pearson and Spearman statistics of the residual pair coincide (both 0.9734 at $L = 11.47$; raw discrepancy 0.12 shrinks to 0.008). The two-constant anomaly of [7] is entirely a prime-wave effect.*

Observation 3 (Exhaustion curve). *Extending the basis to all $p^k \leq Q$ with Q up to 300 (79 frequencies; placebo still $\leq 10^{-4}$), the stripped correlation $r^*(Q)$ rises to a maximum and then declines. The maximum sits at $\log Q_{\text{peak}}/L \approx 0.42$ in every window: below this threshold the waves act as amplitude noise (stripping tightens the pair), above it as common-mode signal shared by gaps and maxima (stripping removes genuine coupling). We denote this role-crossover $\tau^* \approx 0.42$.*

At $Q = 300$ the stripped share of the amplitude log-variance reaches 82–87%, leaving a residual

$$V_{\text{res}}(L) : 0.163 (L=9.86) \rightarrow 0.244 (L=12.45),$$

increasing approximately linearly with slope ≈ 0.031 per unit L . For comparison, the CUE amplitude log-variance grows at ≈ 0.036 per unit N but is six times larger in magnitude at matched dimension. V_{res} is an *upper bound* on the intrinsic randomness of the maxima sequence: our per-frequency coefficients are gap-independent, whereas the conditional-variance anatomy shows the transmission grows with gap width, so arithmetic residue survives the stripping.

6. OUT-OF-SAMPLE VALIDATION AT THE 10^{12} -TH ZERO

All laws above were extracted from heights $t \leq 1.6 \times 10^6$. Using Odlyzko’s table of the 10^4 zeros following the 10^{12} -th [6] ($t \approx 2.677 \times 10^{11}$, $L = 24.475$), we recomputed the entire battery at a height larger by a factor of 1.6×10^5 . Amplitudes were evaluated by an anchor-expanded Riemann–Siegel engine (206,393-term main sum; base phases $\theta(t_0) - t_0 \log n \bmod 2\pi$ computed once in high precision, increments in double precision); at the tabulated zeros the engine gives median $|Z| = 1.4 \times 10^{-9}$ against between-zero maxima of order 3, validating it to nine digits.

The results, with the small-height laws quoted as predictions:

- *τ -law for w* : the linear guide $0.940 - 2.967\tau$, fitted only to small heights, predicts the six measured w_p at $L = 24.475$ to within 0.02–0.07; e.g. $w_2 = 0.871 \pm 0.007$ against the guide value 0.856. The residuals grow mildly with τ (the true curve is not exactly linear), but the collapse variable survives the jump.
- *Sum rule*: $|u_q| = 0.99$ – 1.07 across the twelve frequencies tested (one outlier, $q = 49$, at 1.18) — if anything cleaner than at small heights.

- *Role-crossover*: at this L the crossover law places $Q_{\text{peak}} = e^{0.42L} \approx 3 \times 10^4$, so the entire accessible range $Q \leq 300$ ($\tau \leq 0.233$) should lie *before* the peak: $r^*(Q)$ should rise without declining. It does ($0.901 \rightarrow 0.959$), in contrast to the peak-and-decline seen at $L = 12.45$ over the same Q range — a successful qualitative out-of-sample prediction.
- *Intrinsic variance*: the linear extension of $V_{\text{res}}(L)$ predicts 0.617 at this height; the measured value is 0.650, high by 5% in the direction expected from the (necessarily) incomplete stripping at this L .
- *Effective dimension*: the N_{eff} test is *inconclusive* here, neither confirming nor refuting the constant shifts: $r_{\text{CUE}}(N)$ flattens at large N ($dr/dN \approx 0.008$), so with 10^4 gaps the uncertainty on N_{eff} is ≈ 0.8 . The raw deficit $r_{\zeta} - r_{\text{CUE}}(N=L) = -0.014 \pm 0.006$ is consistent with the small-height value -0.019 .

7. WHAT THIS SAYS, AND WHAT IT DOES NOT

At single-gap scale, the “randomness” of $|Z|$ between zeros is, to two thirds or more, deterministic prime signal carried at full explicit-formula weight; the celebrated CUE resemblance of the gap–amplitude law is a single-statistic compensation, not a model equivalence. None of this bears directly on the Riemann Hypothesis, and none of it is a closed-form claim: the two candidate closed forms this project produced at smaller heights were both refuted by larger- T tests and are recorded as such in the project log. What survives are measured curves — $w(\tau)$, $v(\tau)$, the sum rule $u \approx 1$, the crossover $\tau^* \approx 0.42$, and $V_{\text{res}}(L)$ — each stable across a factor 16 in height and each protected by placebo and exogeneity controls.

Open problems: (1) derive $w(\tau)$ and $v(\tau)$ — equivalently the partition of the unit explicit-formula weight — from a screening theory of the zero gas; (2) explain $\tau^* \approx 0.42$; (3) determine the nature of V_{res} , whose CUE-like growth rate at reduced magnitude suggests a small genuinely-random component of the zero gas; (4) account for the +1% to +12% drift of u_q ; (5) settle the $\tau \rightarrow 0$ limit of the transmission — full transparency $w(0) = 1$ versus a plateau near the extrapolated 0.94 — which requires dense small- τ coverage; (6) recover the discriminating power of the N_{eff} test at large heights, which needs $\gtrsim 10^5$ consecutive zeros there (e.g. from the Platt/LMFDB datasets).

REPRODUCIBILITY

All measurements are scripts 43–52 in <https://github.com/azizran/deney> (directory `qm_riemann/`), runnable from the stored gap–maximum datasets; the dated research log in the same directory records the failed intermediate models (independent-phase and common-phase generative attempts) alongside the results reported here.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

Computational assistance, literature search and drafting: Claude (Anthropic). Errors are the author’s.

REFERENCES

- [1] M. V. Berry, *Semiclassical formula for the number variance of the Riemann zeros*, Nonlinearity **1** (1988), 399–407.
- [2] J. B. Conrey, A. Ghosh, *A mean value theorem for the Riemann zeta-function at its relative extrema on the critical line*, J. London Math. Soc. (2) **32** (1985), 193–202.

- [3] S. M. Gonek, C. P. Hughes, J. P. Keating, *A hybrid Euler–Hadamard product for the Riemann zeta function*, Duke Math. J. **136** (2007), 507–549.
- [4] C. Hughes, S. Lugmayer, A. Pearce-Crump, *The second moment of the Riemann zeta function at its local extrema*, arXiv:2411.05573 (2024).
- [5] J. P. Keating, N. C. Snaith, *Random matrix theory and $\zeta(1/2 + it)$* , Comm. Math. Phys. **214** (2000), 57–89.
- [6] A. M. Odlyzko, *Tables of zeros of the Riemann zeta function*, https://www-users.cse.umn.edu/~odlyzko/zeta_tables/.
- [7] U. Sezen, *The joint law of zero gaps and local maxima of Hardy’s Z -function: a numerical study and a CUE effective-dimension anomaly*, draft (2026), same repository.

INDEPENDENT RESEARCHER, ISTANBUL, TURKEY

Email address: ugursezen@gmail.com